

Roots Martial Arts Academy

Capoeira Cord Criteria and Lineage Notes. Studio at 1615 Broadway, Sacramento. Lead instructor Angela Fry. Lineage under Mestre Pintado of Oakland. Updated February 2026.

How cords work here

Cords mark a student journey, not a finish line. Promotion happens once a year at the November ceremony, where Mestre Pintado observes the roda. A student earns the next cord by showing clean movement, music literacy, control in the game, and care for younger students.

Cord progression

Cord	Stage	What we look for
Raw	Beginner	ginga, basic kicks, safety in the roda
Yellow	Foundation	esquiva, au, simple sequences, the chorus
Orange	Developing	floreios, ground escapes, reading tempo
Green	Intermediate	chamada, rasteira timing, lead a warmup
Blue	Advanced	instructor games, play three toques
Purple	Senior student	teach a kids block, mentor a beginner
Brown	Pre instructor	run a class, hold the bow and the room
Black	Instructor	carry the lineage, train the next teacher

Music and rhythms

Every student learns to hear the berimbau before they learn to beat it. Angola is slow and low to the ground. Sao Bento Grande is fast and upright. Luna is reserved for cord holders. Cavalaria once warned of danger and we keep its story alive in class.

Conduct

Bow in, leave ego at the door, protect your partner. The roda is a conversation, not a contest. Dignity in tone is owed to everyone on the mat.